

Task 16 – Simple Profit Analysis

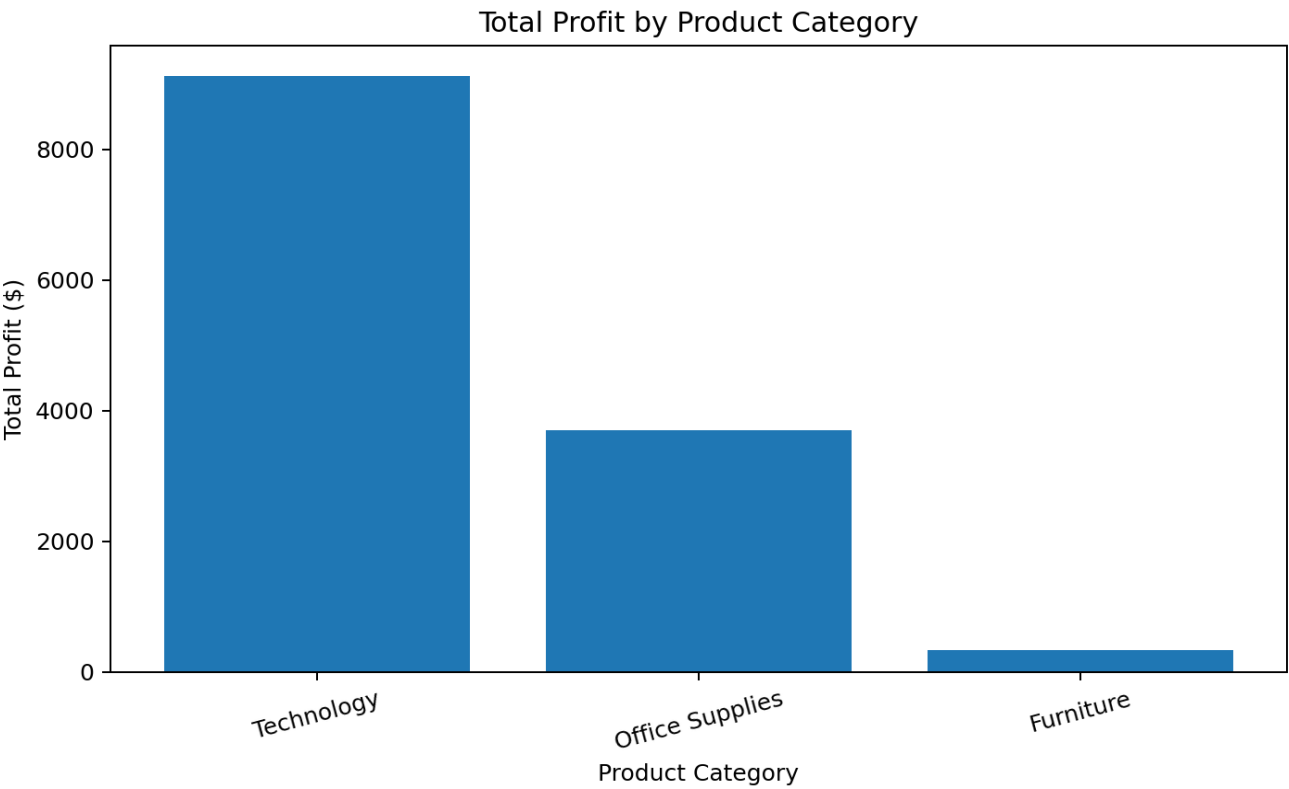
Data Analytics Track • Excel Deliverable

Objective: Compare total profit across product categories and understand basic profitability.

Metric	Value
Transactions	600
Total Sales	\$221,097.02
Total Profit	\$13,167.73
Overall Profit Margin	5.96%
Loss-making transactions	169 (28.2%)

Profit Summary by Category

Category	Transactions	Sales	Profit	Avg Profit	Margin
Technology	155	\$73,257.23	\$9,130.25	\$58.90	12.46%
Office Supplies	251	\$63,575.19	\$3,698.85	\$14.74	5.82%
Furniture	194	\$84,264.60	\$338.63	\$1.75	0.40%



Observation: The category totals differ materially. Technology has the largest total profit in this dataset, while Furniture has the smallest. The category table also shows why total profit should be considered together with

sales volume and profit margin rather than sales alone.

Interview Questions

1. Revenue vs profit? Revenue/sales measures the value of sales generated. Profit reflects the amount left after the costs represented in the dataset. A category can therefore have high sales without having equally high profit.

2. Why can sales be high but profit low? Common reasons include high discounts, high product or fulfillment costs, returns, or a low underlying margin. In this practice dataset, discount is explicitly included so the relationship can be explored in Excel.

Methodology

The dataset contains 600 transaction-level rows with Order Date, Category, Region, Sales, Quantity, Discount and Profit. The Excel workbook groups transactions by Category and calculates total sales, total profit, average sales, average profit, units, average discount and profit margin. A category profit chart is included for the required visual comparison.

Dataset note: this is a Superstore-style practice dataset created for the assignment using the same core analytical structure as the public Tableau Sample Superstore data. Tableau describes Superstore as a sample dataset containing products, sales and profits.